

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ A
♥ 10 8 5 2
♦ 9 8 5 3
♣ A 10 8 7

♠ Q J 4
♥ A K 6
♦ K Q J
♣ J 5 4 3



♠ 7 3 2
♥ J 9 7 4 3
♦ A 10 6
♣ 9 2

♠ K 10 9 8 6 5
♥ Q
♦ 7 4 2
♣ K Q 6

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North

So before playing any trumps play ♥ A K, discarding dummy's ♣ K. That's a lot of winners you are wasting but you can afford it.

Only then can you afford to play a ♠. West can win the ♠ A, but if he plays a ♣ dummy will be able to over-ruff East.

After you pull trumps you can drive out the ♦ A and claim the contract.

As you see, trying even one round of trumps would have been fatal.

You had to get rid of dummy's singleton ♥ first - the fact that it was a winner should not affect your making the correct play.

Partner's 2♥ bid is a transfer so you bid 2♠. Partner now bids 4♠ and you pass.

North plays 4♠. East leads the ♣ 9. West takes the ♣ A, then returns the ♣ 7 on which East plays the ♣ 2.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 3

Careful! Although it looks like only 3 losers you are in real danger of a ♣ ruff. It is almost certain that East has led a doubleton ♣ so if West can get the lead with either ♠ A or ♦ A they will get the ruff.

Fortunately your ♦ s are solid and you do not need the ♥ Q as a winner.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 5 3
 ♥ 7 6
 ♦ 10 5
 ♣ 9 8 6 5 4 3 2

♠ Q 10 8 4

♥ A K 5

♦ 9 8 6 2

♣ Q 10



♠ A 9 6

♥ 9 8 4 2

♦ A K 7 3

♣ K J

♠ K J 7 2

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ Q J 4

♣ A 7

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

1NT

Pass

2♠

Pass

3♣

All Pass

3♣ by East

Many people play Jacoby Transfer convention. Not all of them play that an initial response of 2♠ asks partner to bid 3♣. You use that here and reply 3♣. Everybody passes.

What a terrible dummy! This shows why this method is a good addition to Jacoby Transfers.

East plays 3♣. South leads the ♥Q. North takes the ♥A K, then switches to the ♠Q.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = ? :: Total = 3 + ?

Instead of trying to estimate how many ♣ losers you may have, just tell yourself that you can only afford to lose one! Then you base your plan on that requirement.

You might as well win the ♠A. You need to play the trumps from dummy and the easiest way to get there is to play ♦A K, then ruff a ♦. Now play a ♣ from dummy and play what from your hand?

You may think it is a guess whether to play the ♣K or ♣J, but there is no guessing involved here. You must play the ♣J because North cannot possibly hold the ♣A. Just go back and look at the bidding again. The North hand failed to open the bidding in first seat. And since then you have seen the ♥A K and the ♠Q come out of the hand. That's 9 points and the ♣A would bring that total to 13. Since he passed it follows that he doesn't have the ♣A. Of course he might or might not have the ♣Q, you just have to hope for that card.

It's easy to forget the bidding once you have started playing a hand.

But good players don't forget, they use every bit of information they can get to help them make their contracts. That's why they make more contracts.